

REVERSE DRURY CONVENTION

ABOUT THE DEALS

You will always be in the South position. Either you or partner may open the bidding.

ABOUT REVERSE DRURY

Does your partnership open "light" in third seat?

If you do not do so now, and do not intend to start, then you can just skip to some other lesson - Reverse Drury is only for those light-opening partnerships.

That said, suppose you have passed with this hand:

♠ K 10 8 5 ♥ Q 9 3 ♦ A Q 3 ♣ 9 6 2

and you hear partner open 1♠ in third seat.

If you knew partner had a full-blown opening hand you would jump to 3♠ as a limit raise. But what if partner has made a light, third-hand opening with:

♠ A Q 9 7 3 ♥ 10 2 ♦ K J 8 ♣ 8 4 3

As you see, 3♠ is too high.

Drury 2♣:

Douglas Drury came up with the idea to use a 2♣ bid to allow the passed hand to ask whether the third-hand opening of a Major suit was sound or was light.

LHO Pard RHO You

pass

pass 1♥/1♠ pass 2♣

The 2♣ bid is completely artificial, and asks Opener to further describe his hand.

OPENER REBIDS AFTER REVERSE DRURY 2♣	
return to 2 of the Major	light opening
2♦	sound opening
jump to 4 of the Major	sign-off, no slam interest
anything else	sound opening, descriptive and forcing

By the way, the reason for REVERSE in the convention name is that in the original Drury the meanings of the "return to 2 of the Major" and "2♦" bid were switched. Some people still play the original format, but more have gone to the meanings shown here and called it Reverse Drury.

Later bidding:

Basically the passed hand has already described his limit-raise hand pretty well with the 2♣ bid. Some partnerships build on this by having his next bid indicate whether he holds 3 trumps or 4 but this is not a universally agreed upon method.

More often, Opener just takes control of the auction after his rebid.

Since the passed hand will always use Drury 2♣ when holding 10+ points with support for the Major suit, that means that a jump to 3 of the Major is preemptive, showing LESS than 10 points and at least 4 trumps.

The price for using Reverse Drury:

Consider this bidding:

LHO	Pard	RHO	You
		pass	
pass	1♠	pass	??

And you holding this hand:

♠ 6 5 ♥ 10 2 ♦ J 10 3 ♣ A K J 8 4 3

Don't get carried away and bid 2♣, that meaning no longer exists in your arsenal. Instead you would have to bid either 2NT or 3♣.

The 8 Practice Deals can be considered the equivalent of 8000 more words.

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥10

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♥2

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣Q

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♦5

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 6 5 2

♥ 7

♦ K Q 6

♣ Q 10 9 6

♠ Q 8 4

♥ A K J 5 3

♦ 8 2

♣ A 7 4



♠ A J 10 3

♥ 10 2

♦ A J 9 5

♣ J 5 2

♠ 7

♥ Q 9 8 6 4

♦ 10 7 4 3

♣ K 8 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

3 ♥

All Pass

3 ♥ by North

Lead: ♥ 10

You like partner's ♥ suit but you have very little defensive strength. This is a good hand to preempt the bidding, trying to keep them from finding a ♠ fit.

So you jump to 3 ♥. Partner realizes you don't have any strength since you did not invoke Reverse Drury. He passes and you have bought the contract. It appears that their side might be able to make 4 ♠.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 6 4 2

♥ K Q 5

♦ 8 6

♣ A Q 9 3

♠ K 3

♥ J 10 8 6 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K J 2



♠ Q J 9 8 7 5

♥ A 4

♦ K Q J

♣ 8 7

♠ A

♥ 9 7 2

♦ A 9 5 3 2

♣ 10 6 5 4

West

Pass

2 ♣

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♥ 2

North

Pass

Pass

East

1 ♠

4 ♠

South

Pass

You open in third seat and the bidding continues as shown.

Partner has a limit raise in ♠s and wonders if you have a full strength opening bid. Your 15 point hand is enough to insist on game, but opposite a passed hand you have no interest in a slam.

So you sign-off at 4 ♠.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 2
 ♥ 10 7 4 2
 ♦ A 10 4
 ♣ Q J 4 2

♠ Q J 9 6

♥ A K

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 9 7 6 5



♠ 7 5

♥ Q 9 8 6

♦ K Q 9 3

♣ 10 8 3

♠ K 10 8 4 3

♥ J 5 3

♦ J 7 6

♣ A K

With 11 points in support of ♠s you need to let partner know. The way to do it is to bid 2♣.

Partner rebids 2♦, confirming a full-strength opening bid.

You've told partner you had at least a limit raise, now you need to tell him that it is pretty minimal. You bid 2♠ and everybody passes.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	Pass	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			
2♠ by South			
Lead: ♣Q			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 8 7 5

♥ K 7 4

♦ K Q 7

♣ 10 2

♠ A 3

♥ J 10 5 3

♦ J 9 5 3

♣ A J 7



♠ J 10 9 6

♥ Q 8

♦ 8 6

♣ K 8 6 5 3

♠ 4 2

♥ A 9 6 2

♦ A 10 4 2

♣ Q 9 4

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

All Pass

3 ♠ by West

Lead: ♦ 5

You open in third seat and the bidding continues as shown.

If you thought East had 11 points you'd bid 4 ♠. But you know he has a weak hand - with 10+ points and support he would have said 2 ♣.

His 3 ♠ bid is just preemptive, so you pass.